

2007 The Lisbon Reform Treaty is signed. Bulgaria and Romania join the EU, bringing the total membership up to 27. The Treaty aimed to make the EU more democratic and better able to tackle important issues, such as security and climate change, jointly.



2004 On May 1, the EU takes in 10 new members, most of them former communist countries, in its biggest enlargement.

European parliament

The European Parliament is the only part of the EU that is directly elected by the citizens of its member states. It manages the budget and drafts legislation. It has 736 seats, which are divided between member states in proportion to their population.

